

Psalms 29

The Voice of the Lord

The voice of the Lord is upon the waters
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 • THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Give unto the LORD, O ye mighty, give unto the LORD glory and strength.
- 2 Give unto the LORD the glory due unto his name; worship the LORD in the beauty of holiness.
- 3 The voice of the LORD is upon the waters: the God of glory thundereth: the LORD is upon many waters.
- 4 The voice of the LORD is powerful; the voice of the LORD is full of majesty.
- 5 The voice of the LORD breaketh the cedars; yea, the LORD breaketh the cedars of Lebanon.
- 6 He maketh them also to skip like a calf; Lebanon and Sirion like a young unicorn.
- 7 The voice of the LORD divideth the flames of fire.
- 8 The voice of the LORD shaketh the wilderness; the LORD shaketh the wilderness of Kadesh.
- 9 The voice of the LORD maketh the hinds to calve, and discovereth the forests: and in his temple doth every one speak of his glory.
- 10 The LORD sitteth upon the flood; yea, the LORD sitteth King for ever.
- 11 The LORD will give strength unto his people; the LORD will bless his people with peace.

2 • CONTEXT

Psalm 29 is a majestic nature-hymn calling heavenly beings to ascribe glory and strength to the Lord, then tracing His powerful “voice” through a dramatic storm sweeping from the Mediterranean across Lebanon’s cedars into the wilderness, before closing with the Lord enthroned above the flood, giving strength and peace to His people. Henry reads the repeated “voice of the Lord” (sevenfold) as poetic celebration of God’s sovereign power displayed in nature, meant to produce worship rather than mere admiration of weather.

3 • VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

A call to the heavenly beings (“sons of the mighty”) to give the Lord glory and strength, to worship Him in the beauty of holiness—majestic praise directed to God’s own courts before turning to earth.

Verse 3-6

The Lord’s “voice” pictured as thunder over great waters, powerful and full of majesty, breaking the cedars of Lebanon, making mountains skip like calves—a storm’s power becomes a vehicle for God’s own sovereign voice.

Verse 7-9

The voice divides flames of fire, shakes the wilderness, makes the deer calve and strips forests bare—overwhelming natural forces are entirely subject to and expressive of God’s command; in His temple, all cry “glory.”

Verse 10-11

The Lord sits enthroned above the flood, King forever, and the psalm resolves from cosmic storm to personal blessing: “The Lord will give strength unto his people; the Lord will bless his people with peace.”

4 • MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

The same God whose voice thunders through overwhelming natural forces is enthroned as King forever and chooses to give His people strength and peace rather than merely display raw power.

Application for life today.

Let a genuine thunderstorm or display of nature’s power become an occasion for worship rather than only fear or fascination—consciously trace it back to the God whose voice it echoes. Take confidence from the fact that the God who commands cedars and wilderness is also the God who “gives strength... and peace” to His own people—power and tenderness are not in tension in His character. Bring your anxieties about overwhelming circumstances to the God enthroned “above the flood.”

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. When did you last let the power of nature genuinely lead you to worship rather than just observation?

2. How does picturing God enthroned “above the flood”—above whatever feels overwhelming—change your posture toward a current worry?

3. What would it look like to actively receive the “strength” and “peace” promised in verse 11 today?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).